

Irene Garcés

POSTDOCTORAL RESEARCHER

Centro de Investigación y Tecnología Agroalimentaria de Aragón (CITA), Spain

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Education

World Trade Institute (WTI), University of Bern

Switzerland

DOCTOR IN ECONOMICS (SUMMA CUM LAUDE)

Mar 2019 - May 2024

- Title: "Essays on regulatory heterogeneity effects and International trade"
- Ph.D. courses at Innsbruck University, University of Bern, and WTI. GPA: 5.82/6
- External reviewers of the thesis: Prof. Dr. Peter Egger, Prof Dr. Bernard Hoekman, Prof. Dr. Carmen Fillat-Castejón
- Advisors: Prof Dr. Joseph Francois and Dr. Octavio Fernández-Amador

Carlos III University of Madrid

Spain

MSc IN ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND GROWTH

Sep 2016 - Oct 2017

- Advisor: Prof Dr. Esteban Nicolini. GPA: 8.0/10

University of Zaragoza

Spain

BSc UNDERGRADUATE DEGREE WITH HONORS IN ECONOMICS

Sep 2012 - Sep 2016

- Final prize of the promotion, GPA: 8.36/10
- Advisor: Prof Dr. Gregorio Giménez-Esteban

Professional Experience

2024 - Curr. **Postdoctoral researcher**, Centro de Investigación y Tecnología Agroalimentaria de Aragón (CITA), Spain

2021 - 2024 **Lecturer**, World Trade Institute, University of Bern, Switzerland

2017 - 2019 **Economic consultant**, Management Solutions S.A., Spain, and Norway

2015 - 2016 **Research Intern**, awarded national grant by the Ministry of Education. University of Zaragoza, Spain

2015 - 2015 **Internship at customer and treasury departments**, Grupo Pikolin S.A., Zaragoza, Spain

Publications

Garcés, I., Vogt A. (2024), "Global value chain integration and non-tariff measures", Economics Letters, 111518.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111518>

Abstract: This paper investigates to what degree domestic value added embodied in gross trade determines the formation of non-tariff measures (NTMs) imposed at the border and regulatory differences in technical regulation. We apply a recently developed political economy model of trade policies and global value chains to indicators of NTM restrictiveness. Our results demonstrate that higher domestic value-added content in imports lowers policymakers' incentives to impose trade-restrictive NTM policies in a similar way as tariffs. These effects are heterogeneous with respect to sectors and income groups of the policy-imposing country.

Garcés, I., Vogt, A. (2024), "Patterns of regulatory differences in international trade: intensity coverage and structure", Review of International Economics. 1–41. <https://doi.org/10.1111/roie.12736>.

Abstract: With falling tariffs, the role of regulatory heterogeneity in international trade has become central in recent debates on regional integration and trade costs. However, few studies explicitly take into account the specific nature of the underlying regulatory differences. We propose distinguishing regulatory heterogeneity with respect to the intensity, coverage, and structure of regulations, and present indicators reflecting each one of these dimensions. Enabled by detailed product-level regulatory data based on coded reviews of national legislation, we illustrate the different channels of regulatory heterogeneity at the country- and sector- level. The findings motivate separate treatment of

the different heterogeneity dimensions in the assessment of non-tariff measures in international trade. All indicators are made available in a database at different sectoral aggregations that can be used for descriptive and empirical work.

Fernández-Amador, O., Garcés, I. (2024), “Modeling heterogeneous direct and third-country effects of the trade policy network”, *Review of International Economics*, 33(3), 765-782.

Abstract: This paper derives a structural Melitz-type gravity model featuring heterogeneous trade cost elasticities to estimate indirect and modular effects of trade agreements in a large panel dataset. Indirect or third-country effects are heterogeneous and nest trade diversion and reverse trade diversion. Our results show considerable heterogeneity of trade effects of agreements depending on pair-specific variable and fixed costs. For a single agreement, indirect partial effects are small relative to direct partial effects. However, a counterfactual simulation of the effects of the global network of agreements over 1972–2017 highlights that aggregate trade diversion can be substantial, because of the large and increasing number of existing agreements. Other factors like agreement depth, comparative advantage and specialization patterns of members also condition the potential for trade diversion of trade agreements. **Reports**

Balázs, K. & Cechura, L. & Chakrabarti, A. & Coderoni, S. & Disdier, A. & Garcés, I. & Krisztin, T. & Meinhart, B. & Kuhn, T. & Le Gallo, J., & Legras, S. & Muzzillo, M. & Piet, L. & Podmaniczky, L. & Sanjuán, A.I. & Sckokai, P. & Storm, H. & Varacca, A. & Vedrine, L. (2026). Deliverable D4.2 (D7) Project Management Plan. BrightSpace Horizon Europe project, GA Nr. 101060075 0

Michiel van Dijk (WR), Elena Castellari (UCSC), Ninke Feenstra (WU), Irene Garcés (CITA), Esther Gehrke (WU), Marta Kozicka (IIASA), Christoph Krüger (PBL), Marijke Kuiper (WR), Thijs de Lange (WR), Myrna van Leeuwen (WR), Daniele Moro (UCSC), Marc Müller (WR), George Philippidis (CITA), Hugo Scherer (WR), Inga Schleicher (Thuenen), Maria Schubring (UOXF), Paolo Sckokai (UCSC), Zuzana Smeets-Kristkova (WR), Marco Springmann (UOXF), Viktoriya Sturm (Thuenen), Giulia Tiboldo (UCSC), Ana Sanjuán (CITA), Michael Wogerer (IIASA), Yan Jin (WU), Willem-Jan van Zeist (WR) (2025), “Deliverable 7.2. BrightSpace Project Report on Toolbox Enhancements for Just Operating Space Indicators: Progress report with focus on income and employment related indicators.

Dupont, C., Elsig, M., Francois, J., Iriarte, I. G., Cezar, R., & Aznar, F. P. (2025). A sustainability analysis on the social dimension of sustainable development in the context of the possible EFTA-Mercosur free trade agreement. .

Working papers

Egger, P., Francois, J.F., Garcés, I., Manchin, M. (2024), “Market Access Uncertainty and Trade in Services”, Mimeo. Bern: World Trade Institute, University Bern.

Abstract: We develop an analytical/empirical framework bridging the decision under uncertainty and recent gravity-based empirical trade literature. We examine the impact of policy uncertainty on services trade, focusing on binding overhang (the gap between market access commitments and actual applied policy). The government’s ability to change policies within this gap yields uncertainty for firms regarding market access. Results point to average services trade costs averaging from 6.66% (high-income countries) to 8.51% (low and middle-income countries) and negative average trade volume effects (58.87%-75.22%) due to existing binding overhang. This is comparable to estimates of other regulatory barriers to trade.

Garcés, I., Philippidis G., SanJuán A.I, Xavier. R. (2026), “Bridging ex-post and ex-ante EU social indicator trends: An explorative modelling analysis for SDG4 and SDG5”, Mimeo. CITA

Abstract: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development represents a roadmap for navigating a sustainable path for global human development. At its core are 17 sustainable development goals with indicators covering the three domains of economy, society and environment. In seeking to anticipate progress in each domain, ex-ante modelling is employed, although within the social domain it remains relatively neglected. To fill this gap and taking an EU perspective, this paper combines novel ex-post econometrics and ex-ante simulating modelling. Thus, for two carefully selected social domain indicators (education and gender), a double-lasso econometric panel specification is employed to identify key drivers and estimate their associated effects. Results show that economic growth, lower agricultural employment, higher education expenditure and trade openness, raise post-secondary education attainment rates amongst 25–29-year-olds. Similarly, economic growth, increases in agricultural employment and average years of education, a reduced concentration of income held by the richest and poorest 10 percent of the population and fewer ur-

ban agglomerations, are found to decrease the gender wage gap. Subsequently, these econometric insights are coded into an ex-ante systems-wide multi-regional simulation model. Compared with best-knowledge baseline projections of both social indicators to 2040, a ‘global slowdown’ scenario reveals a relative rise in the gender pay gap and a relative fall in post-secondary educational attainment rates across all EU member states. From a policy perspective, the drivers of tertiary attainment reinforce the importance of EU strategies that promote economic resilience, sustained public investment in human capital, and deeper integration into global markets. For narrowing the gender wage gap, lifelong learning remains key, although the results highlight the importance of income distribution, urban agglomeration and employment in agriculture, which underscores the need for targeted labour-market and social policies to support gender mainstreaming in urban planning and rural development.

Ph.D. courses

- 2019-2023 **Econometrics of trade and investment policy; Economic Network Analysis; Applied General Equilibrium; CGE modeling in GAMS; Globalization, labor markets, and inequality; Gravity models and panel econometrics**, WTI, University of Bern
- 2021 **GTAP-Short course in global trade analysis**, Purdue University, United States of America
- 2019-2020 **Ph.D. courses in microeconomics, macroeconomics, and econometrics. GPA: 1/1**, Innsbruck University, Austria

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

- 2019-2023 **Graduate Research Fellowship**, Swiss National Science Foundation
- 2023 **Award for the best research paper presented by a young scholar at XXIV-Conference on international economics for my job market paper (see above)**, Alcalá de Henares Spain. Spanish Association of International Economics and Finance (AEEFI)
- 2016 **Final prize of the promotion, Bachelor in economics**, University of Zaragoza
- 2016 **Grant for a summer school in big data and digitalization**, Afi, escuela de finanzas
- 2015-2016 **Research grant awarded a national grant by the Spanish Ministry of Education**, Spain

Presentations

- XXV- Annual conference European Trade Study Group, 2024**, Athens, Greece
- XXV-Conference on international economics, Jun 2024**, - Alicante Spain, Spanish Association of International Economics and Finance (AEEFI)
- Workshop on International Trade and Foreign Investment, Feb 2024**, Villars-sur-Ollon, Switzerland
- 48th Simposio of the Spanish Economic Association (SAEe), 2023**, Salamanca, Spain
- Workshop on Computable General Equilibrium Models - “Non-standard features of CGE modeling”, 2023** - Basilea, Switzerland
- XXIV- Annual conference European Trade Study Group, 2023**, Surrey, England
- Workshop on Trade Policy Research Network Workshop Global Governance, Social Welfare, and Inclusive Trade Policy, Jun 2023**, European University Institute, Florence, Italy
- XXIV-Conference on international economics, Jun 2023**, - Alcalá de Henares Spain, Spanish Association of International Economics and Finance (AEEFI)
- XXV-Applied economics meeting, 2023** - Toledo, Spain, Asociación libre de economía (Alde)
- The Brown Bag Seminars – Business & Economics – (BBS), 2023** - University of Zaragoza, Spain
- World Trade Institute, Ph.D colloquiums 2021, 2022, 2023**- University of Bern, Switzerland
- Brown Bag seminar series**, University of Bern, 2023 Switzerland.
- Galbino Project Collaborative Workshop and Summer School Global Supply Chains, Trade and Sustainability, and Policy, 2019, 2022, 2023** Padova, Italy
- Attendance and organization of the ETSG and World Trade Forum, 2019**, University of Bern, Switzerland

Teaching Experience _____

2021- 2023	Microeconomics at Master in Law and Economics (MILE) , Lecturer	<i>World Trade Institute</i>
June 2023	Econometric analysis of trade policy with a focus on trade remedies in the applied trade policy modeling (TRADEMOD) program , Teaching Assistant	<i>World Trade Institute</i>
June 2022	Econometric analysis of trade policy at applied trade policy modeling (TRADEMOD) program , Teaching Assistant	<i>World Trade Institute</i>
Sept. 2022	Working with trade data in the capacity building program for the trade ministry of Saudi Arabia , Teaching Assistant	<i>World Trade Institute</i>

Outreach & Professional Development _____

2022-2023	Brown Bag seminars in Economics, Law, and political science organization , WTI
2020-Curr.	Professional orientation for high school students , Ejea de los Caballeros, Spain
2018	Volunteering in India with disabled children , at Mother Theresa's and children at risk of exclusion at New Light NGO
2008-2016	Volunteering with disabled children , Fundación Caballos de Martincho Farasdués, Spain

Languages and Software _____

Languages: Spanish (native) , English (advanced, IELTS C1), French (intermediate, DELF B2), German (basic, A2)

Software:

- *Statistical Programming:* STATA (advanced), R (advanced), E-views (intermediate)
- *Economic modelling:* GEMPACK (advanced), GAMS (intermediate);
- *Other:* Latex (advanced), Microsoft Office (advanced)

References _____

Prof. Dr. Joseph Francois: Ph.D. Supervisor. Professor of International Economics. Managing Director at the World Trade Institute, University of Bern, Switzerland

Dr. Octavio Fernández-Amador: Ph.D. Co-supervisor. Senior Postdoctoral Researcher at World Trade Institute, University of Bern, Switzerland

Prof. Dr. Douglas Nelson: Professor of Economics at Tulane University, New Orleans, United States of America

Prof. Dr. Carmen Fillat-Castejón: Professor of International Economics at University of Zaragoza, Spain